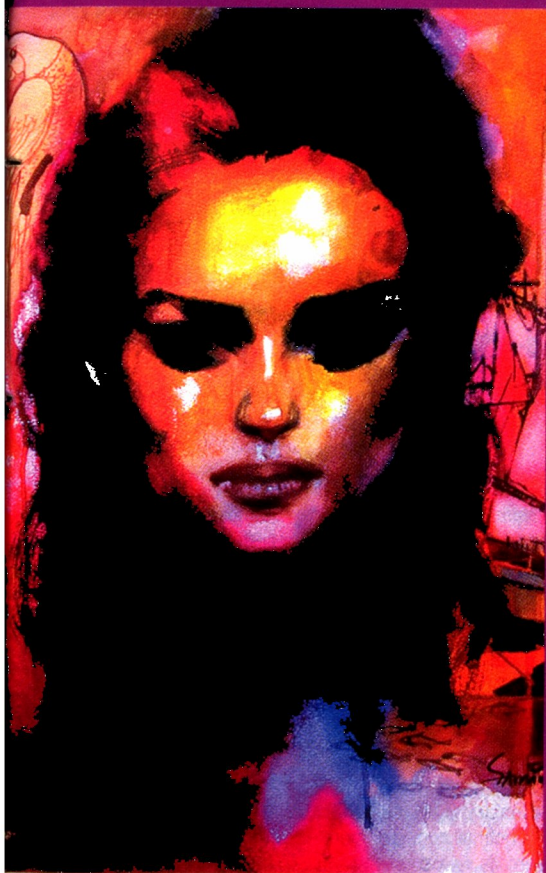


ART EXHIBITION

Brush with the Best



Completing 10 years of being in the art world calls for a celebration and what better way of doing so than bringing together the best in the industry under one roof. On its anniversary, the gallery has hand-picked 10 artists—owner and curator Pravina Mecklai's personal favourites—who will show at the Jamaat. The artists include Ajay De, Ashok Salian, A.V. Ilango, Babu Xavier, Jayasri Burman, Ravi Mandlik, Samir Mondal, Senaka Senanayake, Solanki and Sunil Padwal. Projected as more than just a gallery, Jamaat has come to represent an artistic haven where intense debates have occurred and solutions have been reached. "This is not just a gallery, it is a gathering, as the name suggests in Urdu. I wanted it to be more than just a white cube displaying art," says Mecklai. On display till February 7. **by Swati Mathur**

MUSIC FESTIVAL

Crooning GLORY

In the only national challenge of its kind, DNA Networks is back with Campus Rock. The regional rounds begin in first week of January with the national finals of the *Nokia Hero Honda Campus Rock Idols Series 5* ending in Hyderabad in February. Amateur rock bands from over 10 cities at the college level will aim to compete at the national platform. The contest covers Shillong, Calcutta, Delhi, Indore, Pune, Bangalore, Hyderabad and Manipal. Winning bands in the previous years have had the distinction of opening for international rock stars brought to India by DNA like Bryan Adams and

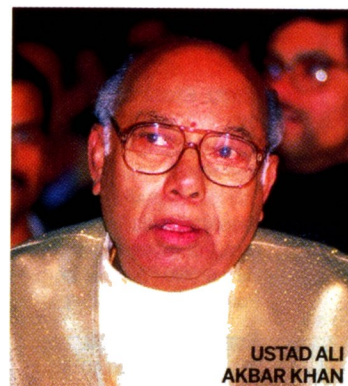


H.K. RAJASEKHAR

more recently Iron Maiden. Besides winning cash prizes the winners will open the concert at Rock 'n India, India's only international rock music festival. **by Nirmala Ravindran**

MUSIC REVIEWS

Back in Bengal

USTAD ALI
AKBAR KHAN

Bengal, the land of Rabin-dranath Tagore, is one of the world's most artistically-gifted regions. This eastern state has given learning a new meaning. Indian classical music has found its most avid listeners here. This series presents 10 such Indian

PRIDE OF BENGAL
Sa Re Ga Ma
Rs 175

classical musicians. They include Ustad Ali Akbar Khan, Malavika Kanan, Pandit Shankar Ghosh and Bikram Ghosh.

Pandit Ajoy Chakravarty and Ustad Rashid Khan. These are archival recordings, which are valuable as such compositions are hard to hear today. Also, one can trace the roots of a style to the earlier days. For example, Malavika Kanan's raga *Chayanat* recorded (1969) or a thumri in Mishar Khamaj, *Shyam gunghat pat khole*, is rich in melody. The rare recording of Sarod maestro Ali Akbar Khan in raga *Lajwanti* (1961) is also enjoyable. So is Sitar maestro Nikhil Banerjee's raga *Maluha Kalyan* recorded in 1966. **by S. Sahaya Ranjit**